

How to offset energy/water consumption of AI

Posted by u/fonoire • 0 points • 3 comments

I'm not sure if this belongs here but figured I'd give it a go. The company I work for is beginning to very seriously adopt AI company wide. I expressed my concerns about this to my boss merely from an ecological standpoint, and he shared those concerns with his boss. My boss is one of the rare ones that supports his team and really cares about our values and passions. His boss (part of C suite) was open to hearing more, so the three of us are going to meet next week to discuss. I want to have some ideas ready, so I'm curious - if you were in my shoes, what might you suggest or what would you want to see your company adopt to even marginally offset the environmental cost it's undertaking by using AI? I'm leaning toward things like 1% for the Planet contributions or donating to organizations that plant trees.

Comments

u/Anticonsumption-ModTeam • 1 points • 2025-09-05 23:04 UTC

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u/ohmeohmyelliejean • 2 points • 2025-09-05 21:50 UTC

Well, I think it's very noble that you're doing this activism but my concern is that the C-suite would use this as a token gesture to deflect from concerns about their using AI.

I would make sure that you're getting across the facts about the impact of AI on the environment and if not introducing it isn't an option, consider cultural nudges about not using AI for trivial things (like how you used to have 'don't print this email, save paper' reminders) and if they're willing to put their money where their mouth is, some sort of donation to acknowledge the impact still is better than nothing.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-09-05 21:41 UTC

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